

Lecture 1a

Intro to Python

Why
program?

Computers
Aren't That
Smart (yet)

Computers will
follow orders
precisely

Do cool
stuff

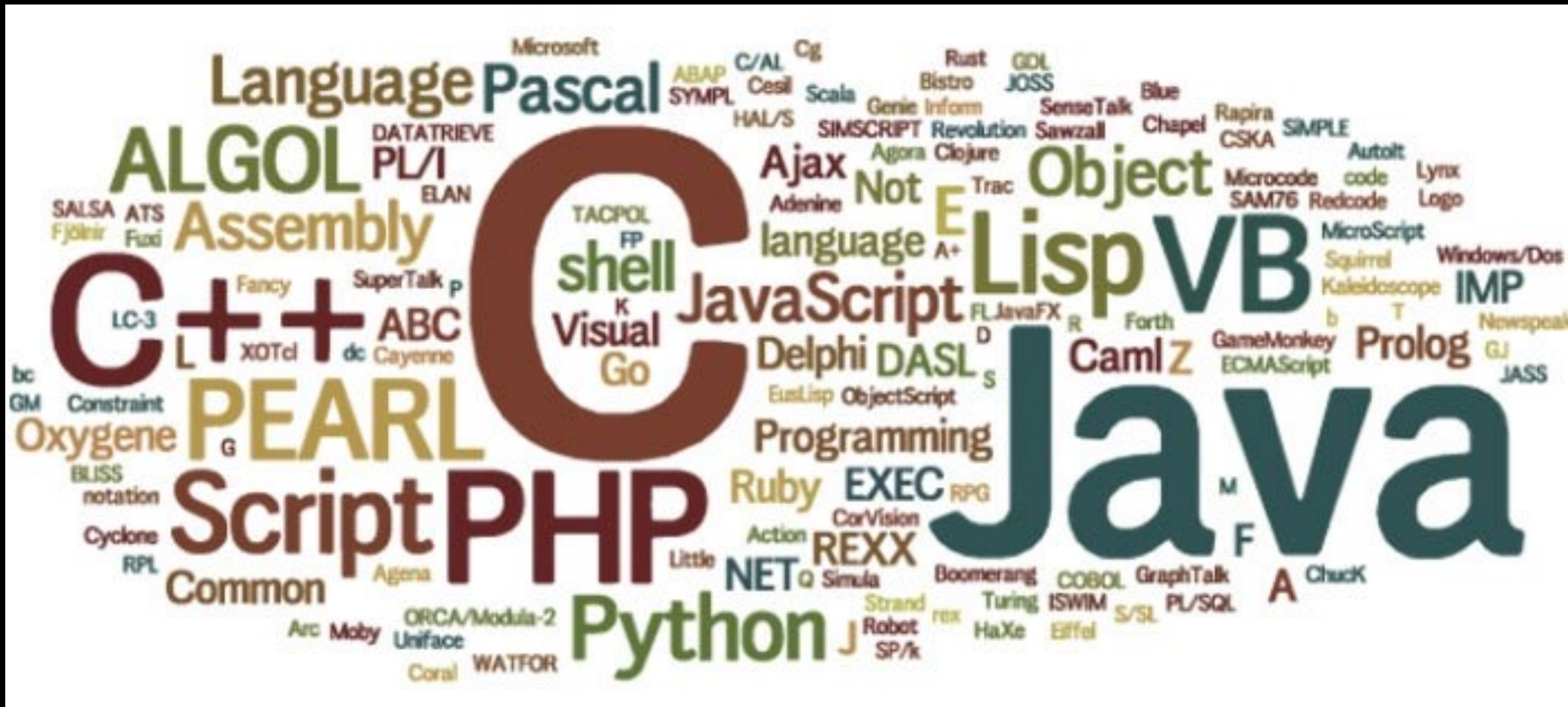
Why Python?

- Powerful open source programming language
- Clear and readable syntax
- Natural expression of procedural code
- Popular

[Read an article about ...](#)

Futile to Teach a Language

(Here today, gone tomorrow)



Program:
communicate a
computational
process

Computational Thinking

Elements of Programming

1. Primitives

–Numbers:

4 , 7/2 , 428.3

–Simple operators:

+ , - , * , /

–Symbols:

a , pi , current_time

2. Means of Combination

$$5 + 3$$

$$8$$

$$((5 + 3) - (2 * 3))$$

$$2$$

3. Means of Abstraction

$$7 + 6 = 13$$

$$a = 7$$

$$a + 6 = 13$$

$$\square + 6$$

Variables

- Start with 'a' – 'z' or 'A' – 'Z' or '_'
- Contain only alphanumeric characters or '_'
- Case sensitive

Coco_Lee != coco_lee

Variables

- Avoid reserved keywords e.g.
`if`
- Python convention: lower case letters separated by '_'
 - e.g. `count_change`

Types

int 8, 45, 1234

float 2.3, 3.141592653

bool True, False

Types

str

"yijc"

'YIJC'

None

Absence of
value, null

type(...)

```
>>> type(123)  
<class 'int'>
```

```
>>> type('123')  
<class 'str'>
```

```
>>> type(None)  
<class 'NoneType'>
```

Type conversion

```
>>> str(123)
```

```
'123'
```

```
>>> float('45.2')
```

```
45.2
```

```
>>> int(23.8)
```

```
23
```

```
>>> int('yijc')
```

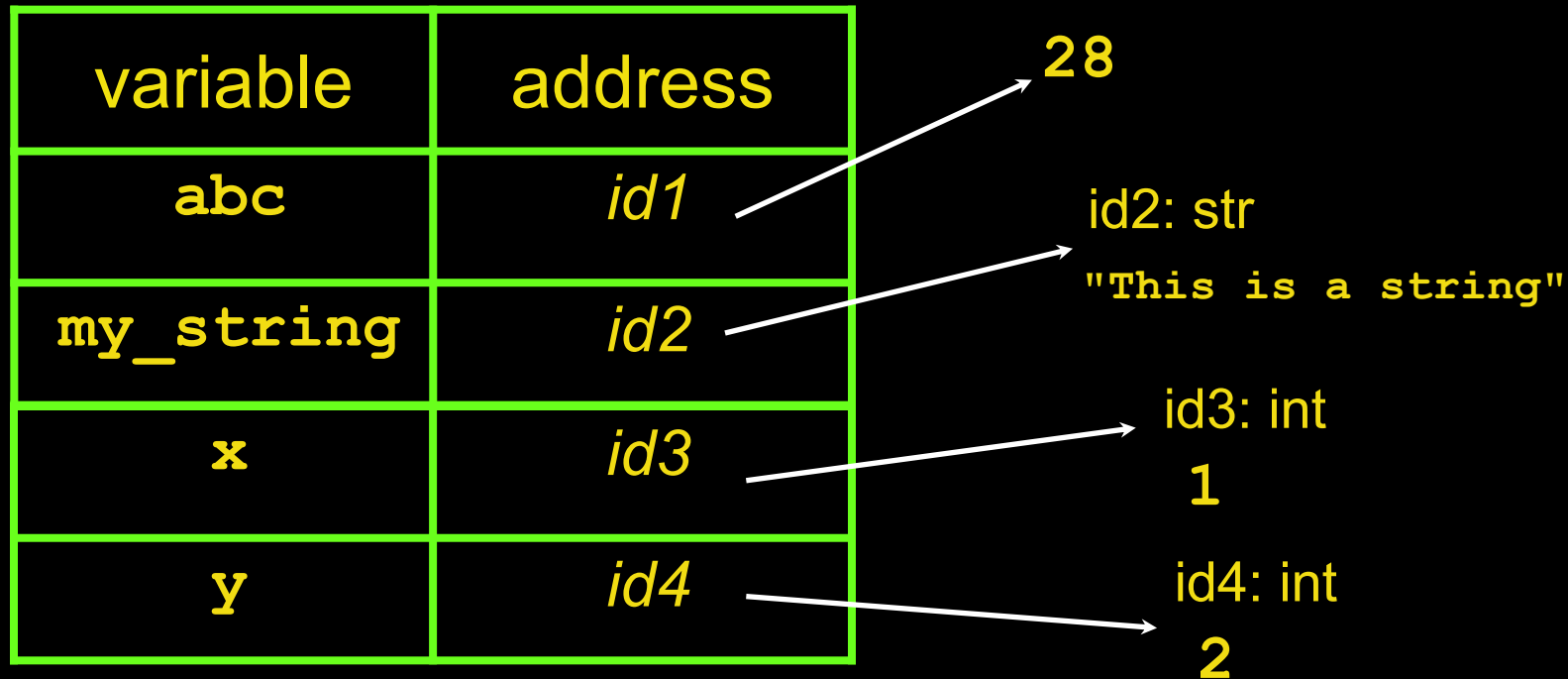
```
ValueError!
```

Assignment

```
>>> abc = 28
```

```
>>> my_string = 'This is a string.'
```

```
>>> x, y = 1, 2
```



Operators

Arithmetic: + - * / ** // %

```
>>> a = 2 * 3
```

```
>>> a
```

```
6
```

```
>>> 2 ** 3
```

```
8
```


Operators

Arithmetic: + - * / ** // %

```
>>> 11 / 3  
3.6666666666666666
```

```
>>> 11 // 3  
3
```

```
>>> 11 % 3  
2
```

Your First Program with Jupyter

Your First Program

```
# This program says hello and asks for my name.

print('Hello World!')
print('What is your name?')          # ask for their name
myName = input()
print('It is good to meet you, ' + myName)
print('The length of your name is: ')
print(len(myName))
print()
print('What is your age?')          # ask for their age
myAge = input()
print('You will be ' + str(int(myAge)+1) + ' in a year.')
```

Dissecting Your Program

The *Comments*

The *print()* **Function**

The *input()* **Function**

The *len()* **Function**

The *str()*, *int()*, *float()* **Functions**

Dissecting Your Program

The *Comments*

```
# This program says hello and asks for my name.
```

```
# ask for their name
```

```
# ask for their age
```

Dissecting Your Program

The *print()* Function

```
print('Hello World!')  
print('What is your name?')  
print('The length of your name is: ')  
  
print('It is good to meet you, ' + myName)  
  
print()
```

Dissecting Your Program

The *input()* Function

```
myName = input()
```

```
myAge = input()
```

Dissecting Your Program

The `len()` Functions

```
myName = input()  
print('The length of your name is: ')  
print(len(myName))
```

Since we can type ... ,

```
print('It is good to meet you, ' + myName)
```

Why don't we type ... ?

```
print('The length of your name is: ' + len(myName))
```


Dissecting Your Program

The *str()*, *int()*, *float()* Functions

```
myAge = input()
print('You will be ' + str(int(myAge)+1) + ' in a year.')
```

Dissecting Your Program

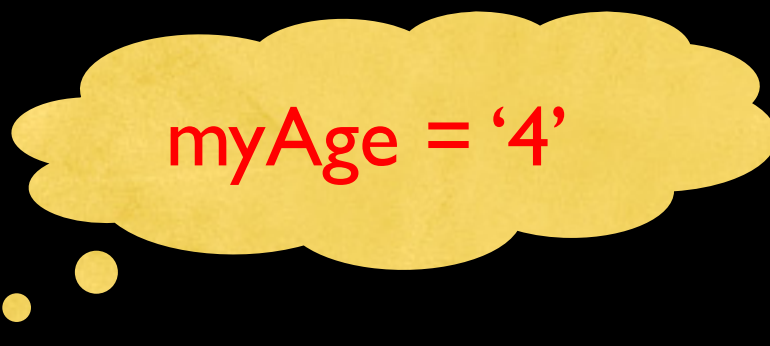
The `str()`, `int()`, `float()` Functions

Try This!

```
>>> str(0)           '0'
>>> str(-3.14)       '-3.14'
>>> int('42')        42
>>> int('42.5')      Error !
>>> int('-99')        -99
>>> int(1.25)         1
>>> int(1.99)         1
>>> int('twelve')    Error !
>>> float('3.14')     3.14
>>> float(10)         10.0
```

Dissecting Your Program

The *str()*, *int()*, *float()* Functions



myAge = '4'

```
myAge = input()
print('You will be ' + str(int(myAge)+1) + ' in a year.')

print('You will be ' + str(int('4')+1) + ' in a year.')
print('You will be ' + str(4 + 1) + ' in a year.')
print('You will be ' + str(5) + ' in a year.')
print('You will be ' + '5' + ' in a year.')
print('You will be 5 in a year.')
```

Text and Number Equivalence

Although the string value of a number is considered a completely different value from the integer or floating-point version, an integer can be equal to a floating-point.

```
>>> 42 == '42'           False
>>> 42 == 42.0           True
>>> 42.0 == 0042.000     True
```

Python makes this distinction because strings are text, while integers and floats are both numbers.